

Medford School Committee Meeting
10.14.2020
Via Zoom

Roll Call: Jenny Graham, Kathy Kreatz, Melanie McLaughlin, Mea Mustone, Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn, - all present

Motion to enter exec session: Melanie McLaughlin seconded: Paulette Van der Kloot

Enter Exec. Session at 5:06PM

Return to Regular Session: 6:31PM

II: Motion to approve bills/transfers of funds

Vote: 6:32 7 affirmative votes 0 negative votes

Motion passes

IV. Report of Secretary: Paulette Van der Kloot: not many bills lately. Expects more going forward.

V. Report of Committees

1. Communication, Engagement and Strategic Planning: Jenny Graham
Orientation practices, district wide communication strategy roadmap: meeting to set agendas for future meetings. November 10: plans around K orientation; December: discussion of technology to enable communication strategies; Jan: Strategic plan; Feb: Orientation practices.
Motion to approve minutes: 7 affirmative, 0 negative
2. Rules, policy and equity: Oct. 7 meeting about calendars and policies of other districts. Meeting in recess until November 4 meeting.
3. Tomorrow is Special Education Subcommittee meeting: 10/15 5:00 PM: building friendships throughout Medford community programs

VI Community Participation:

- Sharon Hayes: frustration with math assessment. Not developmentally appropriate right now educationally and psychologically.
- Response from Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: assessment was an attempt to gather baseline data. Would be given three times a year. Agrees, the timing of this assessment should have been pushed ahead. Will make adjustments for future baseline assessments. Appreciates feedback.

VII Report of Superintendent

Remarks: Welcomed yesterday first grade hybrid students. Admin visited schools to assess safety conditions. Gratifying to see so many students happy learning in a socially distanced way. Medford BOH will host a flu clinic Saturday, Oct. 24 from 9am to 1pm at Andrews MS. Families must register in advance with BOH. All students need to be vaccinated for flu by Dec. 31.

Medford Family Network receiving requests from many families in need of diapers size 4, 5 and 6 as well as wipes. Donations are appreciated. Please contact Marie Cassidy at Medford Family Network. Would like to recognize Delilah Putnam Bagley putting together COVID prevention kits through CCSR. She contributed all dog walking proceeds to purchasing these items. Contributing to Brooks, Andrews and MHS. Last week Delilah was recognized by NBC Boston. We appreciate her thinking of the community at large.

SPED department with Triangle Incorporated hosting college information sessions for students with IEPs and 504 plans Thursday Oct. 29 at 6:30 to 7:45 via zoom.

Cheim@medford.k12.ma.us

Our AP Italian students remind us that it is Italian heritage month in the US. America is a nation of immigrants. The USDA announced free meals have been extended through June 30, 2020 (grab and go breakfast and lunch at all of our schools). October is National Principals Month. Lets thank our Principals and Assistant Principals who have done so much during this challenging time to help families and teachers. We applaud aloof our principals and assistant principals.

I would like to acknowledge the Columbus school - we have hired a co teacher for the 2nd grade class. This transition has taken longer than we have hoped. We have been working diligently on this issue and are prioritizing this classroom where we know there have been many transitions this year.

Lastly, over the past two weeks, we have had our first experiences with COVID affecting our schools. Safety, equity and consistency have guided us through this process to keep all members of our community safe. Thanks to Toni Wray and MaryAnn O'Connor, Tufts and Fallon Ambulance for assistance with testing.

Melanie McLaughlin: thanks to Superintendent Edouard-Vincent for taking on me on a tour of the schools. Very good medicine to see the students in the schools. To see the creativity, and safety mechanisms that teachers have implemented. Our teachers and students do belong in our schools and it is good to see that.

Question about pick up times for lunches: maybe we can use other methods of getting these lunches out there.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: thanks for visiting and thanks for bringing the lunch issue forward about grab and go lunches. We will work with food services to see if there is a way for

people to pick up for more than one day. Please pass on the families who have reached out so we can help them.

Melanie McLaughlin: I will reach out to Mr. Murphy about setting up systems to help with food distribution.

Toni Wray: COVID report

We have been assisting with contact tracing, testing PPE, education and support to the community.

Mary Ann O'Connor: thank you to Delilah and her siblings.

State report: we are still yellow. Today's data has us at 6.7. We need to be vigilant. Medford is climbing (56 cases in last 14 days) 68 cases puts us in the red. Many neighboring communities have gone red in tonight's numbers. 15 of the 56 cases were in the 20 year old age group.

Jenny Graham: question about testing for staff? Does testing continue when staff is in their buildings?

MaryAnn O'Connor: we have a 200 test a week threshold. We are doing surveillance testing and will be making decisions as to who will be retested. Paid for through the CARES act through December.

VII.3 Report on restart and hybrid Implementation:

A. Finalization of metrics:

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent reports will address how we can serve the students operationally and educationally.

Dave Murphy: there is a large amount of information to flesh out. Let's start with the dashboard document which refers to the bricks and mortar aspects of opening classrooms.

Mary Ann O'Connor: scrolling through the document. This document will be updated every Thursday morning by the school administration and will be posted. We are good for next week based on the numbers we have but we will be using this as we move back and forth. We cannot jump if there is one week red.

Dave Murphy: There are two documents that work together. Need to look at the framework for decision making as well.

Melanie McLaughlin: Asked if we go red, do we need to wait the three week period to make decisions?

Mary Ann O'Connor: need to look specifically at the nuances affecting our rates (Tufts students?, school by school?)

Jenny Graham: Section two is incomplete. What about section one? Goal is to say all of these things are in place? In order to say a building is ready, we need to see that a specific building/classroom is ready? Is this going to be provided before we move forward?

Conclusion: need to include all of the grades that are in school?

Intent of the school specific condition was to provide a very specific decision if there are rooms/cohorts are remote instead of hybrid?

That is what the dashboard is missing right now.

David Murphy: First, as Jenny Graham suggested, there is a difference between data we have and data we can display. Clicked on the building readiness checklist (coloring book). All of these are on cycles which need to be viewed on an ongoing basis. There are occasions where for example the electrostatic sprayer will be used more often. Might be counterproductive to display this on a dashboard each time each thing is done. This list provides the standards we use to make sure we fulfill the responsibilities we have to insure safety.

In section three, there are scenarios we can never predict on the dashboard. There is a judgment call the admin will need to make. People in the high school are familiar with the fact that two programs that were moved to remote instruction based on two different situations: one was contact tracing. One was out of an abundance of caution, we decided to be proactive even though it didn't follow the set criteria. We can put more specific conditions in but it is likely we will always be faced with situations that fall outside these parameters. There is always a balance we have to strike - an ongoing challenge we will be facing.

Jenny Graham: The entire point of section three is to acknowledge that there are cases that are going to happen. We will have to make decisions using guidance of Toni Wary and Mary Ann O'Connor. The goal of the dashboard is to list specific situations so people know what the situation is. That is the information families need.

Dave Murphy: there will be situations where we should not publicly acknowledge the specifics of the situation so we don't identify who the cases are? All situations are fluid.

Paul Ruseau: You said we will communicate with those affected. Do we have the ability to know that the communication is received?

Toni Wray: last week, we started with robocall. Followed up with emails and phone calls to those people who didn't get the robocall. We do have mechanisms to follow up and provide the information.

Paul Ruseau: sending an email doesn't mean they haven't received it. Website should also list it. We cannot rely on the technology we have in place right now. Need to put it on a public website.

Dave Murphy: we can be specific and post it on the website but I can envision scenarios and privacy issues we will encounter. You can never say you have done enough on a communications effort. Need to use all methods available to us.

Jenny Graham: if privacy is a concern, then there should be a bullet, say specifically who should check their email. Learned about the situation on facebook before the admin made people aware. If we are not willing to put it somewhere, people will get it from inaccurate places.

MaryAnn O'Connor: appreciate the help of Toni Wray and school nurses, it falls on the Board of Health to get the contact tracing done.

Jenny Graham: not talking about the contact tracing. Talking about contacting the parents whose kids should not attend school the next day. We are creating a situation where we are destined to fail.

David Murphy: we are talking about Toni and the department she represents. We are not lacking here systemically. Let's look at the second document.

Toni Wray: we made updates to this document, added definitions to the list. We tried to clarify distinctions between classes and cohorts. We added some qualifications regarding substitute availability. We added numbers in a key. We heard the feedback seeking visual representation and FAQ pieces to accompany this framework. Identified the situation last week to show how the framework was used to make decisions: mps with board of health.

Laid out two cases where framework was used: one, a staff member at an elementary school that affected more than one class. Two, in a school, one staff and one student tested positive in one school no contact between that staff and student. Teachers and students identified as close contacts were moved to remote instruction.

This framework, while it didn't specifically allude to the situation in either case, it was able to guide our decision making.

Melanie McLaughlin: The definitions and summary numbers are very helpful. Look forward to the visuals and the FAQ. Hopes that Paul Ruseau texeira's team looks into the translatability of these documents. Thank you for all this hard work.

Member Ruseau: thank you for the remarkable improvement over the last version. In scenario b, less than 2% active cases, is it 2% of students?

Toni Wray: students and staff combined in the building at the time.

Paul Ruseau: Not sure what my question is but on the first page "relying on the board of health", the attorney has implied that we cannot inform the whole class if there is a case? Makes facebook the primary source of information. A bad look. Other school districts are not following this mandate. Concerned about how and who we communicate to.

Mayor Breanna Lungo Koehn: what was the progression of notification

Toni Wray: Mary Ann and I met and then presented the information to senior administration. Then robocalls went out and phone calls to close contacts. Whirlwind of activity where everybody shares a part at getting specific information.

Melanie McLaughlin: motion to approve metrics with amendment to include graphics and translations. Seconded by Kathy Kreatz.

Paul Ruseau: positive case, only close contact notified. People run to facebook.

Dave Murphy: there is an operational challenge to having a defined class of individuals to be notified. Point on the public health side, consistent with best practices, not to violate privacy concerns. We can identify communities and contact to provide information. There will be situations where it is difficult to identify a "class" or "school community".

Melanie McLaughlin: point of information, in high needs classes, numbers can be so small that right to privacy goes out the window. There is so much nuance on this. We want to protect privacy.

Jenny Graham; we have identified our groups. I am just asking that we follow our own classifications of groupings. Why are we saying we cannot do this? It is not a FERPA or HIPAA violation.

Melanie McLaughlin: not sure what you are referring to?

Mary Ann O'Connor: close contacts will be contacted.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn; you are using abundance of caution to do a good job of informing contacts.

Melanie McLaughlin: Are there letters going out? Confusion about who quarantines and who doesn't.

MaryAnn O'Connor: there are quarantine instructions that are sent out.

Paul Ruseau: public comment;

Kate Willard: if Medford is in the red, what is the plan?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: DESE recommends three weeks of data to make a determination.

Melanie McLaughlin: motion to approve, seconded by Kathy Kreatz

Jenny Graham: yes, Kathy Kreatz: Yes, Melanie McLaughlin: yes; Mea Mustone: yes, Paul Ruseau: no, Paulette Van der Kloot, yes, Mayor Lungo-Koehn, yes

Metrics approved as amended; 7:55

VII.3.B Operational challenges amid reopening K-12 (slide deck)

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent; presenting the ppt showing the operational issues as of October 14, 2020

David Murphy: today's deadline is not firm for secondary students to decide to switch to full remote.

Suzanne Galusi: showed classroom set up on a k classroom, spread out desks, no shared supplies; hallway signage showing students which way to move; directions outside bathrooms

Links to elementary hybrid schedule; hybrid reflects the remote to make the specials more seamless. Web cameras may be used in a developmentally appropriate manner. Community will be updated as grades come in. Finalizing a special schedule with the teachers association.

Peter Cushing:

6th grade, monday oct. 19. Congrats to our middle school principals and teams for preparing their spaces for students. Pulling together classroom spaces meeting standards. Remote students will be participating in piloting using cameras to view their teachers via webcam. There will be no changes in schedule. Families can switch from hybrid to remote and vice versa at any time. We did a field test yesterday and were pleased with the possibilities.

Mr. Texeira will be presenting an el report at the next meeting.

Joan Bowen: welcomed two hundred students on sept 28 (most vulnerable mon/tues/thursday/friday in school, remote on wednesdays)

One challenge we faced, we needed to move two groups to the remote model and they will move back once we get proper guidance. Desks with plexiglass dividers.

David Murphy: operational updates: two paths we are establishing the air exchange rates we need to meet: ongoing hvac repairs going on in every building; investment in hepa filters; facing supply chain issues but arriving over the last two weeks and expecting more each week. They will be deployed based on the information we have from our vendors. Wireless capacity: dry runs and test drives at middle schools in anticipation of in school instruction next week. Generally a positive experience.

Walkthroughs occurring at each building to make sure safety mechanisms and signage are in place.

Reverse remote in a few situations. We are making sure we have the right technology to facilitate these situations. We have made significant progress in our conversations with the teachers unions

KidsCorners: significant hvac repairs were needed. Hoping to have an update in the near future.

PPE and additional sanitation procedures have been implemented. Some are in daily routine and some are as needed depending on the situation.

Paul Ruseau: going back to slide one: we are not doing surveillance testing?

Toni Wray: Surveillance testing looks at large groups of who are presumed to be asymptomatic.

Mary Ann O'Connor: we are doing surveillance testing with the teachers. (not symptomatic people are surveillance testing)

Paul Ruseau: Tufts students are being surveillance tested. Teachers were tested before they started and then not again. To parents, teachers would be tested every week.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: continuous surveillance testing would be the goal but we are not doing it yet.

Paul Ruseau: time between classes in the schedule, did we expand that time?

Suzanne Galusi: we built in a bit of in between time in k and 1

Paul Ruseau: how can students use bathrooms? Will an entire class be spent waiting for the bathroom? Looking at images of middle school, anxiety about getting to class. Are teachers going to get the message that tardiness should not be treated as it was in the past?

Peter Cushing: teachers supported by principals and asst. Principals will be aware of this situation.

Paul Ruseau: is there pressure to catch up on all the material that was missed in the spring?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: We are focusing on the social emotional health. We know that we cannot make up for all that was lost in the spring. We are not applying pressure on our teachers. We are looking at providing support. Students will need to get reacquainted to being back in school. I want to be clear we are not looking to stress out our students right now. We are looking at the whole child. I do not want to water down the standards for those students who are choosing AP courses. There are students who seek this and want to be proud of their honor society recognition. I agree we need to make sure there is not too much homework but we do need to meet the standards of the college board.

Paul Ruseau: are we choosing the College board over the mental health of students?

Melanie McLaughlin: thanks for this deck. I have a couple of questions. Will it be posted online? (yes) for Joan Bowen, the 200 most vulnerable students who returned; has DESE provided guidance for the red zone for most vulnerable students. If red, we do transition to remote.

Joan Bowen:; I will double check this guidance to see if it is more nuanced.

Melanie McLaughlin: we need to have a plan for these students: in home service, intervention services

Put plan for high needs students in case of RED on next meeting agenda.

Melanie McLaughlin regarding reverse remote, how are they being communicated to?

Dave Murphy : email from principal

Melanie McLaughlin: we haven't discussed high school students; specifically seniors,

Dave Murphy: there will be senior specific communication in the next few days

Melanie McLaughlin: also with our AP students, let's look at how many are taking them and passing them? When we are in a situation of a global pandemic, what is the college board's position during the pandemic?
High School open house was exceptional.

Peter Cushing: students choose the AP.

Stacey Shulman: plan for college board is to have a paper exam in class and possible remote for the pandemic. We are required to follow their guidance.

Paul Ruseau: how do we deal with the mental health of our students right now?

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: not on agenda. Ms. Shulman will present on this on Oct. 26. No further questions on challenges of k-12.

Principal Chad Fallon: presenting on Vocational technical education. Thanks to the admin team who have been working very hard over the past months. They deserve credit. We have an awesome team.

Career and tech ed doesn't necessarily transfer well to remote learning. We continue to engage our students each day. Teachers are doing the best they can in a very difficult situation. Working on securing partnerships for off-site learning. Looking at sites in Medford and Malden to rent. Also looking at Habitat for Humanity for opportunities. Problem is local unions are not keen to have students due to COVID 19. General updates: we have been getting through lots of renovations in our building. Construction in cosmetology salon, painting and construction going on in the building.

Enrollment: 596 students total. Numbers are rising with 196 freshmen.

8 of the 15 programs currently have a waitlist.

Overview of CTE Remote Schedule.

Looking at tents and propane heaters.

Business marketing can be offered remotely, graphic design looking at macbooks, media tech and web design: all lend itself to remote.

It is important to shout out to each of the programs. Teachers are being very innovative to interact with students.

Kathy Kreatz, Paulette Van der Kloot, Superintendent Edouard-Vincent, MCL: thanks for the presentation.

Melanie McLaughlin: Can you please send the video to the school committee? Appreciates all of the work and your thinking outside the box with setting up tents and garage bays. Hope members of the community will continue to partner with the voc. Asked about PPE.

Chad Fallon: Face shields, more gloves, masks. We have set aside some money we can use for covid expenses. Senior admin have been very helpful with identifying items that we might be able to acquire through the Cares act.

Melanie McLaughlin: would have been great to have HVAC in the Voc going forward.

Jenny Graham: Thank you to Chad. Nice to be able to see what is being done in the schools at this unprecedented time. So many things we *can't do* but presentation nice reminder of what we *can do*. Makes for progress in small ways. I have heard from parents that their kids are doing well despite the change.

Chad Fallon: I am lucky to work with the team.

Paul Ruseau: I have a 9th grader and the rotation has been going well.

VIII Old Business:

1. Motion to Approve Suspension Policy:

Breanna Lungo-Koehn read edited policy.

Paul Ruseau Ruseau has three emails from the public.

Kathy Kreatz: not in favor of out of school suspension, but in cases of violence, would administrators use their discretion? Were drugs, weapons, violence addressed in the discussion at the sub meeting? What about victim protection? This is concerning to me.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: would like to define what is permitted by law?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: that was discussed in sub.meeting: by the language except by permitted by law, that meant that if it broke the law, then suspension could take place. I felt that the spirit of Paul Ruseau Ruseau's resolution is to not make suspension decisions quickly. I am in agreement with much of the resolution but need to have the ability to use suspension in cases of violence or danger to others?

Kathy Kreatz: would in school suspended students go back to their class schedule the next day? What does this look like?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent: in school suspension is still coded as suspension. Nationwide, students of color do get suspended more often. We could look at progressive discipline, social and emotional counseling and other measures to correct inappropriate behavior. Putting health, welfare and safety would warrant an out of school suspension. We want to continue to look at our practices, use progressive discipline, and not use suspensions as the first line of action. Let's look carefully at what warrants the level of exclusion? This will be different than in the past but something we will work toward.

Kathy Kreatz: what resources will be offered to the victim? The victim may be afraid to go to school.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent; we would work with ms shulman's dept to provide support to the students involved and look to ways of fostering mediation. We do not want to traumatize the victims. We want to focus on all the students involved in the situation.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: this is something that can be put together before Sept 2021?

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent; yes, working with all school leaders and the counseling staff, it is something we can work on to address completely by sept. 2021.

Jenny Graham: during the meeting, we talked a lot about the metrics. Our data tells us that it is true in medford as well as nationwide. We talked a lot about item number one. Looking at the handbook, suspension is the outcome of so many actions. Permitted by law should be changed to required by law. At ms. shulman's request, #5, the program review will allow this to become operational. In the subcommittee, we also talked about support for victims which is something that it is not happening now. The victim currently has to deal with it when the student returns from suspension. #5 should be amended to say that the comprehensive program review system wide (check tape for proper wording).

Amendment to change it to required.

Amendment to number five to include support of victims.

Amendment to number seven, missing comma.

I understand why people feel very differently about this policy will be addressed in the program review.

Motion to approve policy with the amendments.

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: wants to clarify that we are doing the program review after we already pass the policy.

Believes we need to lay out the plan before we vote to decide to get rid of suspension. Agrees to work on the goal of ending out of school suspension.

David Murphy;

Number one was an attempt at a sub meeting to align school policy with statutory policy. Mute if we move to more aspirational language. There are no laws requiring suspension. There are situations where that decision is empowered. There is no law requiring it. What was clear in that subcommittee meeting, some information was alarming and it heightened the importance of scrutinizing our practices.

Paulette Van der Kloot: Speaking in favor of the original motion. Likes the certainty of “as of”. Puts in motion the need for restorative justice. We are not saying students will not be held accountable for inappropriate behavior. They will be held accountable in a more effective way. The intent is, this is what we are going to do. This is how we will make it happen.

Breanna Lungo-Koehn: How can we vote to make it happen if we don’t know how we will make it happen? Will each principal be able to decide? Will there be a chain of command so that we are consistent and fair?

Paulette Van der Kloot; In my head, agreeing to this is saying, this is what we are doing this year? I see value in making it a declaration.

Paul Ruseau: It was three years ago, the law changed and set for the aspirational goal of changing the policy and it didn’t get done. I want to empower the superintendent to get it done. I think by not getting it done, there will be consequences to students. If not now, then when? As for permitted vs. required, I agree with member graham. The whole sentence is screwed up. The law doesn’t specify what warrants a suspension.

Breanna Lungo-Koehn: Motion to pass the amendment to number 5; roll 7 affirmative. (9:48)

Paulette Van der Kloot: Motion to make an amendment that central admin provide a plan to address this motion in May of 2021 so that there is time to fix it?

Roll Call: resolution stands. 7 affirmative.

David Murphy: amendment presented by the admin (number one). We added as little wording as possible to ensure alignment to the law. By buttressing the statutory requirement with policy requirement, if we are trying to be consistent we can use permitted or required or we can use “except in extreme cases”.

Jenny Graham: likes the word provided instead of required. Think we have alignment on the intent.

Amendment to change the word to provided. Second, Paulette Van der Kloot.

Roll: 9:56. 7 affirmative. 0 negative.

Kathy Kreatz: Can admin still use their judgment?

Breanna Lungo-Koehn: as provided by law and as outlined in the plan.

David Murphy; that will be the opportunity for admin to spell out the very narrow circumstances under which students could be suspended

Four emails:

1. Support changes in school discipline codes
2. Jen lewis russell st. - supports resolution
3. Kate Carson - data shows use of suspension younger and younger. It isn't always bias, it is often the behavior of traumatized students. We are not fixing problems with suspension - we are making it worse.
4. ??

Main motion on suspension: Roll: 10:01; 7 affirmative 0 negative paper passes

Alpha med app policy: David Murphy update

Dissemination of enrollment information to student communities. During the course of discussion, we are still working with two bargaining units on whether to make it mandatory.

Tip Sheet:

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent this was sent to families.

Class size report: we received the report but we already discussed the bubble classrooms and appreciate hearing about what is being done.

Bus Pass information: passes have been disseminated. Funds should have been refunded by now. Bus passes were sold in the lobby a couple of weeks ago.

Melanie McLaughlin: willing to table this. What I am asking is, are we expecting students to pay for their own bus passes to get to school? Is it our responsibility to provide transportation? Looking for accounting of who buys the passes and can we help them financially?

X, New Business:

1. Schedule of committee of the whole meetings
Breanna Lungo-Koehn: going to schedule two meetings a month
10/28 on capital improvements
Will send two dates per month

Asked that members send priorities of items on list

Melanie McLaughlin: Would like to add the out of district review to list of items for Committee of the Whole

Roll: 7 affirmative

Jenny Graham: asked if the mayor has dates?

Breanna Lungo-Koehn; will send it out tomorrow.

2..MCAS Moratorium

Mayor Breanna Lungo-Koehn: asked to change the word demand to request

Jenny Graham: this is language from masc. We cannot pay lip service to social emotional health without standing firm on this.

Melanie McLaughlin: I feel conflicted on this in a number ways about this topic. I am concerned about the accountability with this. Part of this testing ensures there needs to be a measure of what our students are learning. I don't want to forget these marginalized populations where there is not measurability

Paulette Van der Kloot: Melanie's question is a huge topic to be considered. We are spending time and energy and money on testing where it could be spent in better ways.

Kathy Kreatz: I believe in the moratorium. I support the resolution and favor the friendlier wording.

Melanie McLaughlin: what about the students at the low end of the achievement gap? I want some understanding of this issue. I will reach out to MASC.

Jenny Graham: There are places piloting accountability without using MCAS. It is my hope the state prioritizes that kind of work instead of using the MCAS. The student opportunity act will not be giving funding to Mass. schools this year. I am very disappointed with this fact. I don't believe MCAS gives us accountability even in the best of situations.

**Motion to approve MCAS moratorium as amended to use the polite wording: 10:30PM;
Roll: 7 affirmative, 0 negative, paper passes.**

Condolences:

Families of Joyce Skorker, Louise Musto-Choate and Chip Piatti.

Motion to adjourn: ROLL: YES 7 affirmative. 10:32PM